Ronald Andrew (Andy) McGuire

Mindfulness Educator & Certified Meditation Teacher

326 Larkspur Plaza Drive, Larkspur, CA 94939 • Cell: (415) 637-0348
Email: sparkyflashrebob@gmail.com • Web: https://headhearttogether.com

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Dedicated, certified Mindfulness Meditation Facilitator with over 15 years of community and clinical recovery teaching experience and 26+ years of personal contemplative and retreat practice. Certified through the prestigious two-year **Mindfulness Meditation Teacher Certification Program (MMTCP)** under Dr. Jack Kornfield and Dr. Tara Brach. Skilled in translating classical mindfulness principles and modern cognitive neuroscience into accessible, secular, practical tools for clinical recovery populations, adults, and seniors. Deeply experienced in guiding groups through attentional focus training, somatic stress regulation, and compassionate communication.

TEACHING & FACILITATION EXPERIENCE

Founder & Lead Facilitator | Living Mindfully Meditation Group
July 2026 – Present (Larkspur & Marin County, CA)

- Founded continuing weekly contemplative community following the evolution of Marin Mindful Recovery.
- Facilitate weekly 90-minute interactive sessions incorporating focused-attention training, somatic inquiry, and group dialogue.
- Emphasize the integration of the "Two Wings of Practice" (clear seeing and an open, compassionate heart) and practical stress-reduction tools for daily living.

Founder & Lead Facilitator | Marin Mindful Recovery
October 2009 – November 2025 (San Rafael & Larkspur, CA)

- Founded community meditation and inquiry group in October 2009; expanded into a weekly ongoing sitting group in February 2020, serving the community through November 2025.
- Guided weekly contemplative practices, mindfulness instruction, and open group discussions.
- Supported diverse adult participants navigating everyday stress, life transitions, and recovery through evidence-based mindfulness tools.

Meditation Teacher | Clinical Recovery Centers
Marin & Sonoma County, CA

- **Azure Acres Recovery Center (Sebastopol, CA)** • ***October 2022 – February 2023*:** Facilitated experiential mindfulness, attention training, and somatic self-regulation groups, helping clients recognize autonomic fight-or-flight triggers (e.g., abdominal tightness) and cultivate emotional balance and resilience without self-judgment.
- **Bayside Marin Recovery Center (San Rafael, CA)** • ***October 2020 – February 2022*:** Designed and taught ongoing "Meditation for Recovery" curriculum for residential clients.

Meditation Facilitator | Whistlestop Senior Center
March 2019 – August 2019 (San Rafael, CA)

- Taught weekly guided meditation and mindfulness classes specifically tailored to older adults.
- Focused on gentle body-scanning, stress alleviation, pain management support, and fostering social connection.

Volunteer & Community Support | Spirit Rock Meditation Center
2000 – 2008 (Woodacre, CA)

- Supported and volunteered for the weekly Monday Night Sitting Group led by Dr. Jack Kornfield and guest teachers, assisting with event logistics, welcoming attendees, and community orientation.

CONTEMPLATIVE CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

- **Certified Mindfulness Meditation Teacher (MMTCP)** | *July 2020 – January 2023*
  Graduated from the comprehensive two-year Mindfulness Meditation Teacher Certification Program taught by **Dr.**

Jack Kornfield and **Dr. Tara Brach**, in partnership with the Awareness Training Institute and the Greater Good Science Center at UC Berkeley.
Curriculum Focus: Secular mindfulness instruction, trauma-informed facilitation, cognitive attention training, loving-kindness and self-compassion practices, diversity and inclusion, and community group dynamics.

- **Formal Practice Inception:** Began continuous, dedicated daily meditation practice in **2000** (26+ years of personal contemplative practice).

SILENT RETREAT & IN-DEPTH STUDY HISTORY

- **Annual Extended Silent Retreats (2000 – Present):** Completed at least one 7 to 10-day intensive silent meditation retreat each year for over 26 consecutive years.
- **10-Day Vipassana Courses (2002, 2003, 2005):** Completed multiple rigorous 10-day silent Vipassana meditation retreats in the tradition of Sayagyi U Ba Khin / S.N. Goenka (North Fork Vipassana Center), practicing 11 hours of daily seated meditation and systematic somatic body scanning.
- **Spirit Rock Meditation Center (SRMC) Retreats:**
  - Concentration / Jhana Retreats (2007)
  - Recovery & Contemplative Healing Retreats (2007, 2x)
  - Annual Labor Day 5-Day Retreats with James Baraz et al. (2002, 2003, and September 2026)
  - Family and community retreats
- **Monastic Contemplative Study:**
  - Spirit Rock Monastic Retreats (2008)
  - Abhayagiri Buddhist Monastery Thanksgiving Monastic Retreats (Yearly since 2008)
- **Intensive Solo Practice:** 10-Day Guided Self-Retreats (2017, 2018).
- **Wilderness Solitary Inquiry:** Four extended Vision Quests (2001, 2007, 2014, 2021).

CORE COMPETENCIES & INSTRUCTIONAL SKILLS

- **Attention & Cognitive Focus Training:** Teaching focused-attention anchoring (breath/sensory anchors) and open-monitoring to mitigate digital distraction and mental fatigue.
- **Somatic Stress Regulation:** Helping students deconstruct physical fight-or-flight tension (tight stomach, clenched muscles) as conditioned biological reflexes rather than personal shortcomings.
- **The Parable of the Two Arrows:** Training students to clearly separate raw sensory input (First Arrow) from narrative catastrophizing and secondary distress (Second Arrow).
- **Mindful Communication Dyads:** Guiding partner listening and speaking exercises to develop non-defensive presence and empathy in personal and professional relationships.
- **Trauma-Informed & Inclusive Pedagogy:** Creating welcoming, psychologically safe classroom environments adaptable to students of all backgrounds and physical abilities.